

Flat Chat

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC



Bill Shipton's 3000 Mk1 BN7

NOVEMBER 2010

**NEW MEMBERS - NEIL AND MARIE HEILBRUNN
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AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat Editor
Patrick Quinn



ON THE COVER

An experience 35 years ago lit a fire under Bill Shipton that compelled him to own this fire engine red Austin-Healey. Story on page 10.

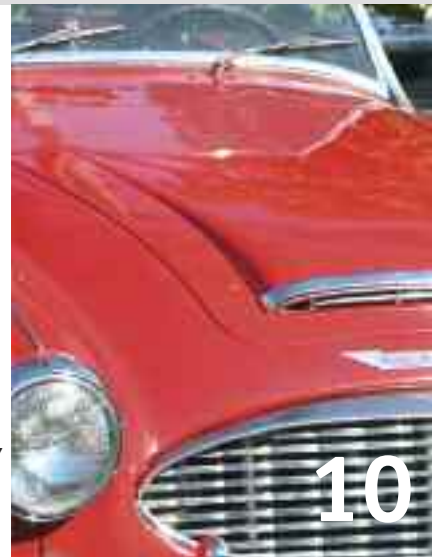
Flat Chat

NOVEMBER 2010

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DATES FOR YOUR DIARY 2010

NOVEMBER

- 6 • Drive to Quinn's home at Kurrajong Heights as part of Australian Open Garden Scheme followed by dinner at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel
- 10 • Annual General Meeting
- 14 • Vehicle inspection day at Richard Horwood's residence
- 17 • Committee Meeting
- 27 • Fish and Chip run to Pan and Doug Ross's home

DECEMBER

- 8 • Christmas Dinner at Rydalmere Bowling Club
- 19 • Car display at Kincumber High School

25 • Christmas Day - As a generous present send the editor photos of you special Christmas Austin-Healey gathering

JANUARY

- 12 • Monthly Meeting
- 19 • Committee Meeting
- 26 • NRMA Motorfest

FEBRUARY

- 9 • Monthly Meeting
- 16 • Committee Meeting
- 27 • Wings Over Illawarra

If you have any questions about the above events please contact our club secretary Pamela Ross on (02) 4332 0075 or 0408 436 595. For competition events contact Patrick Townshend on 0407 075 997

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

TERRY BANCROFT

I am finally back in the chair, after a very upsetting couple of months. May I say again how overwhelmingly touched we were with all the phone calls, cards, emails, flowers and personal encounters from friends across Australia and around the world who have heard and responded to our grief. Thank you all again.

On 10 November we have our Annual General Meeting. Please come along and show a little interest in the functions of your Club. Our Club is a lifeline for Austin Healey information, friendship and outing/social activities and it needs you to come along and show other members you want your Club to succeed.

I have placed a motion before the Committee to have the annual fees reviewed. Our membership fees have been static for close on to 20 years and well overdue for review. With increases in costs in almost everything the club is involved with, the current fee of \$50 for a single membership is insufficient and I believe that we are way overdue for an increase. Accordingly I have suggested that the membership fees be increased by \$10.00 per annum. The increase will be debated at the November Committee meeting and I urge all Committee to be in attendance.

John Kent really has his teeth into the Wings Over Illawarra scheduled for the end of February 2011. From what I have heard and read, it sounds like an absolutely top day and not to be missed. The crowning glory of course will be, as Austin-Healey is the 'Marque of the Year' it will not cost you anything to enter.



CLUB COMMITTEE

2010

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Public Relations
Richard Horwood (As Above)

Non-Committee Positions

Competition Assistant
John Kent

Librarian
Stuart McColl

CMC Delegates
Ray Roberts/Charles Britten

Assoc of British Car Clubs Rep
Terry Bancroft

Please do not call committee members after 9pm.

Flat Chat is published on behalf of the Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW (Inc) by Vintage Racecar Journal Pty Ltd., 116 Warks Hill Rd., Kurrajong Heights NSW 2758

The opinions expressed in *Flat Chat* are not necessarily those of the Editor or the AHOC (NSW) (Inc).

Austin-Healey Owners Club of New South Wales

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ANNUAL

Christmas Dinner

.....

Rydalmere Bowling Club

8 December 2010 • Please be seated by 6.30pm

The cost for members will be \$15.00 and for non-members \$25.00.
Special diets can be catered for.

Please let Patricia Bancroft know by Friday 4th December if you would like to attend. Money to be collected at the November meeting or please send a cheque to PO Box 3027 Llandilo, NSW 2747 so that it is received by 4th December. All queries to Patricia on (02) 4777 4883

Austin-Healey



Greetings and welcome to the November 2010 issue of Flat Chat. Sadly this month we mark the passing of Michelle Bancroft, the daughter of Patricia and Terry Bancroft. While not a member, Michelle's contribution to our club was important. When you read through Alan Mitchell's words on page 16 you will see that it was Michelle who was commissioned to design our website. I suspect that we have all had the occasion to look closely at the site and we should be proud that it stands out amongst similar sites from clubs throughout the world. Once again I am sure that I speak for everyone when I pass on our condolences to Pat, Terry and the Bancroft family.

The main feature this month is on the BN7 of Bill Shipton. It starts off as an interesting tale of a young boy who was highly enthused when given a ride in a neighbour's Austin-Healey. The car was an almost new BJ8 neighbour belonging to inaugural member Robert Harrison who incidentally bought it new and still has it. Bill's enthusiasm was fired up during the 1960s and he managed to maintain it until 2007 when he bought his first Austin-Healey. But as you will read, one was not enough.

Thinking of having new carpet fitted to your Austin-Healey? Did you know that more carpet goes into an Austin-Healey than in a Chevrolet Impala? I didn't, but I found out when I had our car recarpeted earlier on this year. What puzzles me though, is how I managed to have the rubber gearlever boot on upside down for close on to twenty-five years. You can read all about it starting on page 14.

Unfortunately we do not have one item, car or spare part for sale in this month's issue of Flat Chat. Keith Drake did send me an ad for his BJ8, but withdrew it when it had been sold. Well done to Keith! So while there is a little news on cars for sale at auction I would have liked to have seen some items for sale in

the classifieds – PLEASE!

Talking about things/service for sale or trade you would have probably noticed an increase in advertisements in Flat Chat of late. This has been done quite deliberately as the aim is to have a self financing magazine as we move through 2011. However I believe there are limits in the number of ads that a magazine like Flat Chat can sustain. After all what is the purpose of Flat Chat? To convey news and entertainment for its readers or be a vehicle for advertisements. Personally I think it's the former.

So at the last committee meeting I suggested that starting from the combined December/January issue the size of the magazine should be increased to 24 pages from its current 20. I am please to say that the Committee agreed. So watch this space.

Meanwhile enjoy the November 2010 issue of Flat Chat.



40TH AUSTIN-HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY

Join the Rally!

To Register for the 2011 Rally please complete the following:

- 1. The 2-page REGISTRATION FORM**
- 2. The 1-page ACCOMMODATION BOOKING FORM**

When you have completed all 3 pages please post (do not email) to:

**2011 NATIONAL RALLY
Marlene Williams
49 Vincent Boulevard
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AUSTRALIA**

No initial deposit for rooms required, payment for room will be charged and payable at the end of your stay. Rooms will be allocated on a first in basis so be sure to complete and return your Registration quickly to avoid disappointment. Receipts will be issued for all monies received.

If you wish copies of the registration forms either look at the website below or send me an email at p_cquinn@tpg.com.au



WWW.AUSTINHEALEYSA.COM.AU



■ MONTHLY MEETING DATE: 13 OCTOBER 2010

MEETING COMMENCED: 8.02 PM

Apologies: Tony Williams, Patrick Quinn and Caroline Quinn, Stuart and Diana McColl, Greg Denning and David Williamson.

New Members/Visitors: Richard Pinkerton and Margaret Smith.

■ PRESIDENT

• Pat and Terry overwhelmed by support from AHOC members from all states.

- Acknowledgement for Michelle on the Webpage and Magazine.
- AGM next month. Please come and vote.

■ VICE PRESIDENT

• Jim Phillips, Colin Rule and Doug Ross along with David Mould who drove from Inverell all attended Glenn Boyd's funeral. That's mateship.

■ SECRETARY

• Request to members from Secretary – asking that there be a dedication placed on the Website for Michelle Bancroft, since she was the person who set up the website originally for the Club. Members agreed to this. Alan Mitchell to word a dedication.

Incoming Mail:

• Thank you card from Heather White – *"Thank you to all members of the Austin Healey Club for your support."*

• Thank you card from Sue Cairns – *"Thank you for the years of happy driving and fun the Club gave to David. He had always wanted a Healey and in 2001 his lifelong dream came true. His experience of owning the Healey was made even better once he joined the Club and he had a great time on Club runs and at Club events. He was made very welcome at meetings – something that really impressed him since he was not strong on the technical side of Healeys. Just goes to show there is a place for everyone. So thank you one and all for the friendship you gave David, the support he received when he was ill, and for the wonderful memories I have of spending time with Dave in the Healey. Best wishes to all in the AHOC."*

• Posters from National Rally in Victoria 2010. Club members at the meeting took theirs, and Pamela to send others in the mail shortly.

• National Bandanna Day 2010 information – 29th Oct

• Information on Mudgee MotorFest 2010 – (Cudgegong Cruisers Inc) 15th-17th October

• CAMS – information about upcoming events, and also about club forum, and elected positions. Also Licensing and Accreditation Guide received and available for members.

• Information from Aust Post about gift cards being available

• Information about Classic Yass meeting – 6th-7th November 2010

• Information about Rally One – racing instruments available

• Information about Mt Buller Sprint – Dec 3-5th 2010

• CAMS carnival at Echuca- Moama postponed due to lack of entries.

• Information on Shannons' Le Mans French Connection.

Outgoing Mail:

• Condolence Card to the Bancroft family upon Michelle's passing.

Magazines: Most 2 months

- Yass Antique Motor Club Inc
- Australian Sporting Car Club Inc
- Healey Torque – New Zealand
- Healey Howl – SA
- Healeys West – WA
- Healey Torque – Qld
- Hundreds and Thousands – Victoria

■ TREASURER

• The current balance in the cheque account looks healthy at \$20,559.08 but the real picture is that after you deduct \$440 in un-

presented cheques and \$15,841 held in trust for Charlie's Run, Members Funds drop to \$4,275. The only outstanding accounts that are outstanding are the costs of hiring the room for tonight's meeting and the cost of the October magazine, yet to be received, which should be around \$1,450.

The Cash Management Account balance is currently \$17,410.99 and \$60,000 in Term Deposits.

■ SOCIAL SECRETARY

• Christmas party money being collected this month and next.

• January presentation day at the home of Belinda and Cameron – information in the next two magazines. Highly recommended to club members.

• Run to Caroline and Patrick Quinn's garden followed by dinner at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel – (lovely meal.) coming up on 6th November.

• Put the Club's Concours on your calendar. Wings over Illawarra – last Sunday of Feb 2011. Two motel bookings including (**Contact John and Carolyn Kent for information (02) 9498 8193) – substantial car parking and security behind the hotel. Members decided to send invites to all East Coast Clubs.

■ EDITOR • Apologies

■ COMPETITION SECRETARY • Apologies

■ HISTORIAN

• Goodwood – several Healey members attended along with numerous celebrities. Some very interesting racing.

■ REGALIA/P.R.

• Shirts (going very cheap) and other regalia. Please buy some by negotiating with Richard Horwood. (including some (Healey car) points)

■ LIBRARIAN • Apologies

■ CMC DELEGATE

• Eastern Creek meeting was quite profitable.

• Next outing is President's run and the Truck and Bus Museum at Leichhardt is one of the destinations.

• Public liability insurance is being investigated.

• Request to put the CMC back on our list for our Magazine. (*send to Patrick)

■ ALL-BRITISH

• Next year 28th August and over \$9000 to Arthritis Foundation for children.

■ CLUB REGO • Nil

■ MEMBERSHIP

• 37 people, plus one and half Healeys. (Richard and Colin Rule's model - ** see show and tell)

■ GENERAL BUSINESS

• Many of the Healey events etc. throughout the world are born from strong club membership and interactions between clubs across countries such as Australia and the world.

• Charlie's run starts Saturday. Heather White invited to join us at Karuah for lunch.

• Ray Roberts – websites. British Pathe – type in 'BMC' and you can see interesting footage. One on Twin-Cam and a Sprite

• Go into Cronulla RSL website – sub clubs – motoring enthusiasts club..... the Oasis runs are listed. Very interesting runs.

• Colin Rule and Kerry have visited Trangie where he comes from.

Spent time with fellow club members. Suggested tour of Golden West - making Trangie the base, and meet other club members. Lots of interesting motoring sites. Accommodation at Trangie Caravan Park - train carriages and onsite vans available plus own van sites at \$20 per night and stay 3 nights and get one night free. Very affordable.

■ **FOR SALE/WANTED**

• Charlie Britten has a caravan for sale. 17 foot pop top - as new. All amenities included. Asking \$20,000.

■ **SHOW AND TELL**

• Terry - two 1970 Flat Chats - and a handbook etc. from a person at All-British Day. Being donated to the library.

• Don Read - old dealership manuals, gained from dealerships and parts books..... when club was starting. Also - hairspray ad featuring an Austin Healey driven by a model.

• Christine - Speedo BJ8 (framed)

• Richard - various instruments including dual speedos.

• Don Hardie - Austin-Healey watch from eBay.

• Colin Rule - model Mark 1 BN7 - client in Tasmania who owns the Jim Clark Lotus openwheeler as well as an Austin-Healey. Ordered a half scale car the same as his full size - yellow over black originally.

• Marissa Rowland sent a DVD of the rally.... And Stuart Turner spoke. This speech in the library at their clubhouse.

MEETING CONCLUDED: 8.45PM

SOCIAL SCENE *by Patricia Bancroft*

I will not be standing for the position of Social Secretary next year this will be the second last report that I will be presenting. Whoever takes over from me, I hope will have more people attending events than I have had. I have continually asked for input for places or events you would like to attend - and unfortunately have received very little feedback.

Anyway here we go for the last 2 months of 2010 and into the first couple in 2011.

NOVEMBER - Saturday 6th. A drive to Caroline and Patrick Quinn's home at 116 Warks Hill Road, Kurrajong Heights for afternoon tea, followed by dinner at Kurrajong Heights Hotel, if you would like to. Caroline and Patrick have been asked to open their garden as part of the Australian Open Garden Scheme. Entry to any garden in the Australian Open Day Scheme is \$6.00 per head, with proceeds going to charity. Parking for Austin-Healeys is at 143 Warks Hill Road. Afternoon Tea can be purchased and there will be a small gift shop and plant sales. Meet at the parking area opposite the RAAF Base on Windsor Road, Clarendon for departure at 2.00.p.m. **Sunday 14th.** Annual Vehicle Inspection day at Richard Horwood's abode from 8.00.am until 2.00 pm. BBQ and tea/coffee available. **Saturday 27th.** Fish and Chip run to Pam and Doug Ross' home, 13 Harbour Street, Bateau Bay. Please be at the old checking station at Berowra at 4.30pm for a departure in convoy at 4.45pm. Please let me know if you will be attending so that Pam can advise the manager of the shop. Would like to know by the 25th November please. **Sat/Sun 27th** - 28th HSRCA Tas-

man Revival, Eastern Creek.

DECEMBER - Wednesday 8th.

Our Christmas Dinner to be held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club [our usual meeting place, but no meeting that night]. Prices for the evening are \$15.00 for members and \$25.00 for non-members. I will DEFINITELY need numbers by Friday 4th December. If you need special food please let me know, as they are only too happy to oblige. I will take money at November meeting or send a cheque to PO Box 3027 Llandilo, 2747, made out to AHOC [NSW] Inc. to reach me no later than 4th December. **Sunday 19th** - Car display at Kincumber High School as well as Carols by Candlelight.

JANUARY 2011 - Sunday 16th. AHOC Presentation Day to be held at the home of Belinda and Cameron Sell at Winmalee. Information on time etc. will be in the December Magazine. This event is free for members and \$5.00 for visitors. I will also need to know numbers for this event so that we purchase enough food.

FEBRUARY 2011 - Sunday 27th - Our concours will be held in conjunction with "Wings over Illawarra" and Austin-Healey will be the marque car for the event. There will be no entry fee for Austin-Healeys. John & Carolyn Kent (02 9498 8193) are organising this day for the Club, so please keep the date free as we would like a great roll up.



MEMBERSHIP REPORT

CHRISTINE LYTTLE

The Club's membership is currently at 249.

New member this month:

Neil Heilbrunn from Martinsville on the Central Coast. Neil has purchased a 100 that was previously owned by Barry and Jane Allertz. Welcome Neil and hope to see you at an event soon.

Members who have rejoined over the last month are Roy Pinder, Bruce and Rosemary Hart and Mark Righini and Bronwyn Lyons. Great to have you back in the Club.

Our Conditional Registration inspection day will be held on Sunday 14 November at Richard Horwood's abode from 9am - 2pm. A BBQ will be held for those who come along to have their Austin-

Healeys checked. Please remember to bring your membership form with you (they will be available on the day if you forget), your payment and proof copy of insurance for your car.

In advance I would personally like to thank Richard for holding this event and the time that Neville Stirton takes to check our most valuable Austin-Healeys. Rod Richards usually comes along and helps Neville by checking the lights, indicators, horn etc - hope we will see you again Rod!!!

Plus all members are welcome even if your Austin-Healey is not on Conditional Registration!!!

Look forward to seeing all the members at an event soon. ■

Profile: Neil & Maria Heilbrunn



Name: Neil & Maria Heilbrunn

Occupation: Neil - Retail

Where Do You Live? Martinsville – Lake Macquarie

What model Austin-Healey? 100 BN1

Why did you buy an Austin-Healey? Of course I have known about them for years, but my real introduction came about when I was taken for a drive in one. I have Vauxhalls as well and through them came to know Phil Bicknell, who I understand is also an AHOC member. We were visiting and he took me for a drive in his and from that moment I fell in love with the Austin-Healey. Phil really put the thought into my head and it all fell into place from then.

Did you specifically set out to buy the model that you bought? After the run in Phil's car I started looking about to see what was for sale. I didn't have any specific model in mind, just knew I wanted an Austin-Healey.

I went along to a Shannons auction in Sydney to have a look at a 100/6. I was interested, but when I looked closer thought it was rough and expensive. Then they auctioned off a BN1 in Melbourne. It was a good looking car, so I made contact with the owner and found out that it had fibreglass front guards. The funny thing was that he told me that the cars came out new like that.

Then I went to have a look at a BN2 that Steve Pike had for sale. After that it was a 100/6 at The Healey Factory that was fitted with a Toyota Celica gearbox. It's not that I didn't like the cars I saw, as I did, but I wasn't really attracted to any of them.

We came back home and of course fate showed its hand. I saw the BN1 on eBay and it was only about an hour's drive from home. The car was for sale by Barry and Jane Allertz who were club members. So we did the deal and the car was mine.

What was it like when you bought it? It was quite rough around the edges, but importantly it was a very usable car. A number of things weren't fitted, but they did come with the car. Things like the bumpers weren't fitted, but then I made contact with Keith Taylor of Wamberal, who has been a wonderful help to me in the short time I have owned the car. Keith gave me a bumper and I bought the overrides from The Healey Factory. Just lately Keith also gave me a front apron.

The brakes were a bit suspect when I bought it. Probably due to lack of use, so I fitted new seals all round. That was easy enough, but bleeding the system was very difficult and took me a long time before it was the way it should be. I have been involved with old Vauxhalls and British motorcycles since the early 1970s and quite used to their idiosyncrasies. However the Austin-Healey is a very different car than a Vauxhall. Actually I was thinking of a MG TC before buying what I did, but the Austin-Healey is a much better thing.

How have you been using the car? I use it to go to work in. It's great as I like to use and enjoy the car. I think there is something about the 4-cylinder cars. They are more nimble, more enjoyable to drive and just more fun. I am not into concours, but I would like to tidy the car a little.

I would also like to find out more of its history. Before Barry Allertz it was owned by Ben Sellers and there's the name of John Sherman in amongst the papers that came with the car.

There are also a few things I would like to do to the car like stopping it jumping out of second and reverse gears. (That led to an in-depth discussion on the vagaries of the BN1 gearbox, indent balls and selector rods.) I am also not too sure about the colour. It was supposed to be supplied new to Larke Hoskins in Sydney finished in Carmine Red, but it's certainly not now.

100 BN1 History Postscript. At this stage little is known of the early history of Neil and Maria's car. What is known is that Ben Sellers did buy it from Ross Astles who had completely dismantled it to the bare chassis. However Ross decided that he didn't want to go through a long term restoration and bought a 100/6 from Joe Armour. That car is now in Queensland.

Was it owned by John Sherman before that? Perhaps John can assist? ■



Want to Start Something?

Are you finding your car harder and harder to start these days? Common symptoms are that when the starter is engaged the motor turns over sluggishly, and/or the motor seems reluctant to fire. Thanks to Neville Stirton, who had this problem put to him recently, I thought it a subject that could be of interest to everyone.

Before jumping to conclusions and replacing the battery, distributor or other major components, there are some simple checks which should be carried out.

1. First of all, are your battery posts and terminals clean and tight? The best battery in the world can't get power to the starter motor through dirty or loose connections.

2. Secondly, there should be an earth strap between the chassis and the engine, and the connections each end of this should also be clean and tight.

3. Next, a good way to check your battery is to connect a fully charged starter pack across your battery terminals. If the starter motor now turns over at normal speed, then your battery needs either charging or replacement.

4. Only after you have carried out these preliminary checks should you go to the next step in the cycle – you guessed it – the starter motor. If the starter motor needs servicing, not only will it be turning over the engine too slowly, but it will be drawing excess power from the battery and will be reducing the voltage at the ignition coil, resulting in a weak spark. At this stage, you should remove the starter motor and take it to a competent auto electrician for servicing.

The recommendations so far apply only if the starter

motor is sluggish. If, however your starter motor is turning the motor briskly, but the engine is still reluctant to fire, then there could be other causes:-

5. Are you getting a good spark? A simple way to check this is to remove the coil lead from the distributor cap, and hold it close to the engine while you operate the starter. If all is well there should be a good fat spark, at least 1/4" (6mm) to 1/2" (12mm) long. If not, you should check out your ignition system as outlined in earlier Technical Articles. If you have a good spark however, it is time to check your choke system.

6. When you pull your choke cable, are both jets being pulled down approx. 3mm to 6mm at the carburettors? Have a friend sit in the car and pull the choke fully on while you watch the carburettors. If not, make the appropriate adjustments.

NOTE: Just as important, make sure the jets return to their normal running positions when the choke cable is fully closed. If one or more jets are sticky and do not properly return, your engine will continue to burn rich even after it has warmed up.

To sum up, if all of the above checks and adjustments are carried out, your car should start first time every time. If not, expert advice should be sought.

THE CLASSIC CONNECTION

1/29 EDWARD STREET, RIVERSTONE, 2765
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 FAX NO: (02) 9627 1309

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Proprietor: John Dowsett AMIAME



I am always interested in how current Austin-Healey owners first became interested in the marque. Sometimes it through a relative, friend or perhaps they have seen one about and admired the style of our favourite cars. To most it's been a long held admiration and desire that's finally come to fruition when there is a little extra time and money. But I was little surprised when I received the answer from club member Bill Shipton.

"It's all Robert Harrison's fault." Bill said.

Well, I'm not too sure that Robert can be blamed for many things, but to have led Bill on to a path of sports car ownership is not something that I would be overly concerned with.

It goes back 35 years or so when Bill was about 10 or 11 years of age and who lived just across the road? Yes it was Robert Harrison who had not long beforehand brought home his brand new 3000 BJ8 – which he still has. Now a young lad of such tender years (Bill, not Robert) was no doubt quite taken by the sparking jet black sports car so Bill went and introduced himself to its owner.

You can imagine the conversation when Robert, keen to make an impression on the young Bill Shipton asked whether he would like to go for a drive. You could also imagine the enthusiasm of the younger Bill Shipton when

he was then whisked up to Dobroyd Point in the 3000.

Did it leave an impression? "I decided there and then that I wanted one." Bill let on. "Even at that age I was so taken by the car. Its lines, the noise, the smell and the way it hung on the road really won me over. I wanted one and knew one day that I would."

Of course we all know that deciding that you want something and actually getting one can be two different things. Like I have decided that I'm going to buy a Birdcage Maserati and tow it behind a current Bentley Continental Coupe.

Years Later

The years have moved on and the young Bill Shipton had been working in IT for some years and he and his partner Lisa Boes found themselves working in Vancouver, Canada. Actually it was Lisa who was there first working as a nurse and Bill contributed to the coffers of various airlines for a while, before he gave up his job in Sydney and joined her. He received an 18 month working visa and found a job working for the Royal Canadian Mounted Police. Not long after, when the funds were just right, Bill decided that it high time to do something about his long held desire of Austin-Healey ownership.

"I sough have made up for not having one for so long." Bill said. "Not long after I made the decision, I found a BN6 right in Vancouver and bought that. It had spent all its life in Vancouver having been sold there new. It felt good, but the itch wasn't satisfied, so I started looking around for a second one."

"I was certainly aware of the different models and that there were both two and four seat versions of the six-cylinder cars. I did think back to Robert's car, but I decided that I preferred the earlier versions as I find their shape more flowing and pleasing. I did look at a MkI four-seater in San Francisco, but decided not to buy that. Then I heard of a BN7 that was for sale in Arizona. The thought of having a BN6 and a BN7 really appealed, so I bought it and had it shipped to where we were living in Vancouver."

BC Austin-Healey Club

"While there I joined the Austin-Healey Club of British Columbia." Bill added. "Can't say that we were involved in vary much, but it was good to be a member. All that was in 2007 and it was at the end of that year we headed back home and shipped out both cars along with 14 boxes of Austin-Healey parts."

"It certainly was a big day when both cars finally arrived in early 2008. Yes I was quite excited when the cars arrived and very pleased indeed that neither of them were damaged in the move. All in all the only damage was to the BN7 when it was cleaned here in Australia as part of the port clearance, and some of the engine bay asbestos insulation was broken by the water blaster. The shipping was done without a problem, however it was a little traumatic when I heard that the ship went from Vancouver to Hong Kong and then steamed right past Sydney for Melbourne. Thankfully it then turned around and came back to Sydney. Didn't quite understand why they did it that way."

"Both cars then went into storage." Bill said. "It was an interesting experience when it came time to register the



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BILL SHIPTON'S 3000 MKI BN7



cars as the BN6 is a little modified and carries quite a few repro parts on it. Needless to say it sailed through without a problem. The BN7 is by far the more original of the two and looks it. It failed! The steering box needed rebuilding. Pleasingly neither car had any rust problems."

Registered

"Both the BN6 and BN7 were fully registered, but as happens I didn't get to use either." Bill lamented. "I originally had the idea of using the BN6 as a track car while having the BN7 for Sunday touring. However we decided that our home was in need of some dramatic work so time and energy was pointed towards that. So 12 months later that slowly came to an end."

"I am tempted to convert the cars to right hand drive and know that it would probably cost around \$2,000 each for the parts. What I didn't want was to have someone else do the work and end up with a big bill, plus I am more than capable at doing the work myself. Strangely enough, in the end I have found that I have just gotten used to driving a left hand drive car and really don't find it a problem on Australian roads."

"When I bought the BN7 it was painted silver." Bill added. "Can't say that it was a good paint job, more like someone





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had just blown over it with the spray gun. So after it had been on our roads for about six months I decided to take it back to its original Colorado Red. So I removed the guards, doors, bonnet and bootlid and resprayed the whole car. I'm certainly not a spray painter, but I am quite pleased with the result. So much better than the silver. In amongst going to work and doing things around home all up it took about three months to do the job. I also managed to find a two-seater hard-top while we were in Canada and have since found another one. One of these needs a restoration, while the other is okay to use."

Some time has now past and like most of us Bill is thinking of his future. After many years in the IT industry he sees light at the end of the tunnel. Bill has launching into the book retail industry and using his IT background, will be offering his wears on line. Such things cost money of course and he has decided that he could be persuaded into parting with his BN7. Of course his details will be passed on. ■



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After 4 children, sundry dogs and uncountable soakings over 26 years left the carpet in the Quinn Austin-Healey looking decidedly worse for wear.

Two years ago I decided it was time to replace it. However you can't rush these things as other priorities arise demanding whatever spare dollars that may be about. And such mundane items as new carpet for the Austin-Healey can't take priority over highly important items like a new washing machine or the like.

The subject of "What about the heat?" raised its ugly head. We all know that our cars are renowned for being hot cars. With your feet stuck up next to the engine with just a thin piece of metal protecting you they get hot, very hot. So hot in fact that I have seen rubber shoe soles melt.

Originally the floor covering consisted of first tar paper directly on the metal followed by a jute underlay and then the carpet. Once I was a keen originality enthusiast, but now more interested in comfort and eliminating the heat. Luckily around the world there are a number of suppliers of complete carpet kits, but our car is quite different around the cockpit so it had to be trimmed in the old fashion way – piece by piece.

In a production Austin-Healey the gearbox tunnel consists of a single piece of metal or fibreglass. In ours there are 5 separate pieces as well as a vertical covering behind the engine that is made up of 4 pieces of metal, riveted together. So it was a matter of removing every thing and reassembling while ensuring any gaps were filled with glued soft, compressible and heatproof rubber. Interesting (I think) as during this process I worked out that for 25 years I had the rubber gearlever boot upside-down, allowing it to let in a cyclone of hot air.

Carpet Decision

I have had work done before by Bill Ogg of Hytone Trimming of Riverstone and had no hesitation in heading in that direction once again. Immediately came the first decision – the colour of the carpet. Tough decision as I had it done beforehand in a pale blue Jaguar carpet. This time it was a Heritage brand carpet in sky blue and pure wool. It's made in the UK by the same manufacturer as Wilton. However without the assistance of both my wife Caroline and Bill I doubt whether I would have ever made up my mind.

"They certainly needed doing as they had discoloured badly." Bill Ogg said after the job had been done. "But the biggest concern was that Caroline couldn't sit in the car for any length of time, especially on a hot day. I suspect that as it was a prototype they wouldn't have taken much attention to the creature comforts as you would with a production vehicle."

"I could see that you had sealed the gearbox tunnel so the first job was to apply insulated foil/foam around the firewall, the front of the gearbox tunnel and sewn into the underneath of the carpet. The Heritage carpet is 42 inches wide so that it easily fits across the back of an Austin-Healey cockpit which is 41 inches. This makes it easier as there is no need to turn pieces around to make them fit. Most carpets have a nap so if a piece is turned around it's easy to see."

More than an Impala

"It took 4.5 metres of carpet to do your Austin-Healey." Bill said as I looked on rather startled. "By comparison a Chevy Impala takes 3.8 metres as while the Austin-Healey is a much smaller car; it is more intricate with all the tunnels and vertical surfaces. Originally the main floor pieces in an Austin-Healey were not bound, as with a FJ Holden. Honestly, while original I think that's a bit cheap and nasty, plus you wanted yours bound."

"I put in insulation everywhere I could get to, except for the sills because I wouldn't be able to get the kickplates on if I did. We added the insulation to behind the main seats, added it to around the rear jump seats and removed the back seat belts while filling the holes. The whole floor, tunnel and firewall is now insulated which it wasn't before. We could have used an American product called Dynamat, which while made for sound deadening is also excellent for insulation, but with so little room between the bottom of the seats and the floor I thought better of it."

Bigger Job

"It was a much bigger job than I expected." Bill added. "Only because the car had been played with before and such areas like the wheel arches had been cut short and not glued down. The handbrake gaiter was torn and the foam padded armrest had to be replaced. The job was very labour intensive and included the carpeted parcel shelf



that had vinyl sewn around the edges. Plus with the insulation having to be cut to size and then glued to the back of the carpet, meant that virtually it had to be trimmed twice."

"Plus I made sure that everything we did was waterproof which is especially important in a sports car, especially an old English one. Maintenance is a breeze. If it gets wet, it's just a matter of hanging it up to dry. There will be a little piling and fluffing due to it being new, but a few sweeps with a vacuum cleaner will be enough to get it looking like new again. It's a much better carpet than you had in it before."

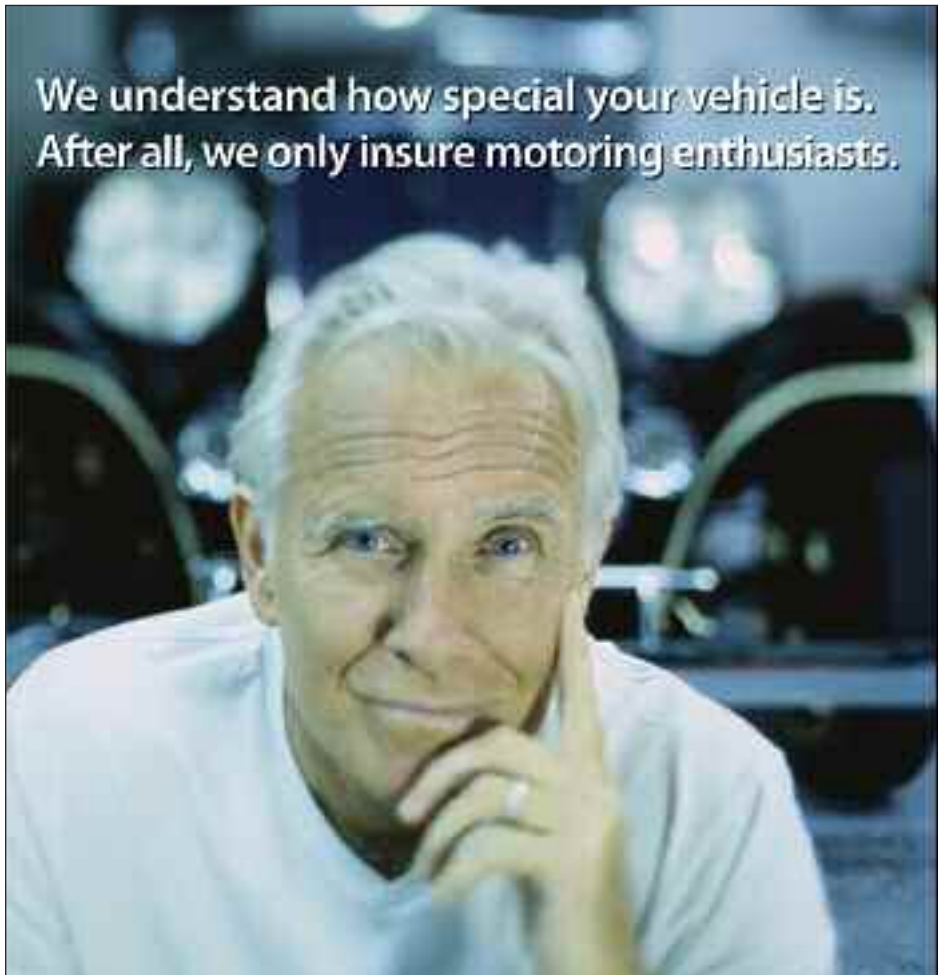
In response to my question on how long the job took, Bill answered. "All up it took two and a half days, plus \$700 worth of materials. Normally it would take about a day and a bit to recarpet a car, but with yours it was far

more intricate. It was a fiddly way of doing it, but there was no other way and to provide the insulation you wanted. I am very pleased with the result."

Everyone Pleased

Yes I can say that everyone was pleased. Just a week after it was finished we joined with the Club for a run to the Central Coast. It was a lovely afternoon and evening and later Caroline said to me that it was the most comfortable she had ever been in the car.

A month later I was concerned about scuff marks on the new carpets so had Bill make me up a couple of fitted floor mats in a contrasting dark blue. Then over Easter we motored for 1,800 miles and attended the National Rally at Creswick, just north of Ballarat in Victoria. The car performed perfectly and importantly looked fantastic and was comfortable. Thanks to Bill of Hytone Motor Trimming. ■



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This month we look at two photos from 1974.

No prizes for guessing the location of where the eight Austin-Healeys are, but why were they there? Well it all was to do with the Club's magazine – Flat Chat. Back then we printed our own with an ancient Gestetner duplicating machine. This meant that all contributions had to be re-typed on to special sheets that were run through the machine. Interested club members would congregate monthly at the editor's home for the printing and collating of the individual pages.

Apart for having the Gestetner sheets professionally typed, we also had approximately 12 months worth of covers printed and it was the photo of the Austin-Healeys in front of the Opera House that was used for the cover.

The cars? Front – L-R. Don Black – 100, Joe Armour –



100/6, Red 100 – Unknown, Robert Harrison – BJ8. Behind – L-R. Patrick Quinn – 100, Noel Laughton – BT7 Mk1, Barry Birch – 100, Doug Treloar – BJ8.

The second photo was taken at the Amaroo Park hillclimb. Yes there was a hillclimb there, but I recall it being rather narrow. It looks as if someone masquerading as a young Barry Birch is either dancing a jig or trying to induce a laugh from everyone else. Form the left is Ben Sellers (living on the mid north coast) and sitting next to him are Anne Read and Caroline Quinn (who both had different surnames back then). Standing are an unbelievably young Don Read, Barry, Chris Gray (living in New Zealand) and Ian Thompson (in Western Australia and a member of the WA club).

That's the Birch E-type coupe in the background and the Quinn BN1 (now in the US).





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Austin-Healey Owners Club - Website Design



Some 6-7 years ago the during an AHOC general meeting it was suggested that we should move with the times and set up our own website. The decision was made to take this plunge and establish our Internet presence, so Michelle, who was developing and hosting websites for other customers, was asked to provide advice and assistance.

We needed a site that allowed the Club to promote the marque, provide information to Members who are not able to attend regular meetings or events, and which enabled us to retain our "identity" and colour structure.

Michelle, with some suggestions and guidelines, set about drafting some ideas which were reviewed by the Committee and presented to Members. It was agreed to proceed.

Michelle established and commenced hosting the Club's website. It was the first website that "popped up" when anyone Googled "Austin-Healey" and remained so for at least 2 years.

The site sparked interest from both "Big Healey" and Sprite fans and through the email address we were getting "hits" daily from people interested in our club and the marque.

Michelle was always willing to look at opportunities for us to enhance the site and continued giving expert advice and assistance.

Over the years as Michelle's cancer impacted her personally and her availability to host the website, so the Committee realised that we needed to manage the site ourselves to enable Michelle to focus on her health. Michelle's outstanding work provided to the Club with a solid basis for our next "release".

The Club and especially those members of the Committee who worked so closely with her at that time would like to express our thanks to Michelle for the time spent and her groundwork that helped the Club to establish itself on the Internet.

Working with Michelle was always fun though it was sometimes challenging to restrain her enthusiasm when thinking of ways to enhance our presence.

Thank you, Michelle.

Alan Mitchell



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Auction News



While there have been Austin-Healeys aplenty coming up for auction around the world I thought a couple close to home may be of interest.

In my editorial last month I made mention of a late series BJ8 that was coming up for sale at the Shannons 24 October 2010 Melbourne auction. Finished in red over white with chrome wires and carrying Vic registration AH-8000, it is an ex US car, that according to the Shannons information was restored in NSW before finding its way to Melbourne. I have no idea who the NSW owner was, but the seller had owned the car for close on to 10 years before deciding to part with it. The good news for the owner was that it did sell at auction for \$68,000 which seems like a very respectable price for a good looking BJ8.

The second car is a BN6 which is not quite up for auction, but it is for sale by private treaty through Sotheby's Australia. Interestingly there are a number of BN6s up for sale at the moment in Australia. Have a look at The Healey Factory's website and you will find at least two.

Just 4,150 BN6s were assembled at Abingdon and of these 263 were in right hand drive. In

amongst these were a number supplied in CKD form or exported Completely Knocked Down to be assembled in their country of destination. Of these a handful in LHD went to Mexico and Cuba while 85 were shipped in RHD form to South Africa.

The car for sale by Sotheby's is one of those that were originally shipped CKD to South Africa. From the beautiful B&W photo you will see that it's finished in white. It also comes with an original two-seater factory hardtop. Worth a look if you were interested in a two seater six-cylinder Austin-Healey.



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Recently restored BJ7 owned by John Southwell

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Richard Horwood showing off his set of speedos at the October meeting. Anne Read Photo.



Joe Armour and Christine Lyttle sharing Goodwood stories after the October meeting. Anne Read Photo.



Club member Paddy Hearne with friends near Trangie. Colin Rule Photo.



Items for Show and Tell at the October meeting. Anne Read Photo.



Club Members about to embark on the 'Codock II' on 12 October. Allan Whitehouse Photo.

Chris Comer enjoying his 100 in a Regularity event at Wakefield Park. Steve Oom Photo.



Bret McManus in his MGB gives the Austin-Healey 3000 of Peter Jackson the hurry along at Wakefield Park. Steve Oom Photo.



Pam Ross looking out for flying elephants on the North Coast. Doug Ross Photo.

Austin-Healeys on show at the Yamba Motel during Charlie's run. Allan Whitehouse Photo.

